



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2024 Version A for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05170) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2024**

Courses Audience: **54**

Responses Received: **18**

Response Ratio: **33.3%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

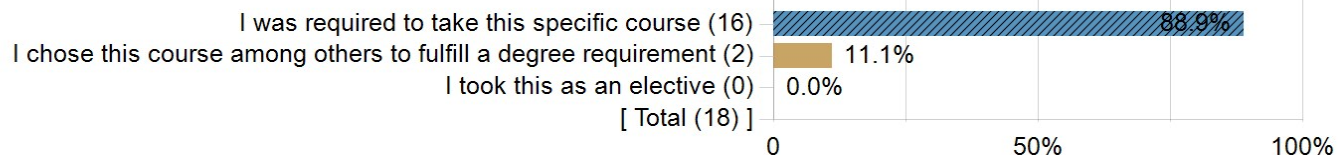
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

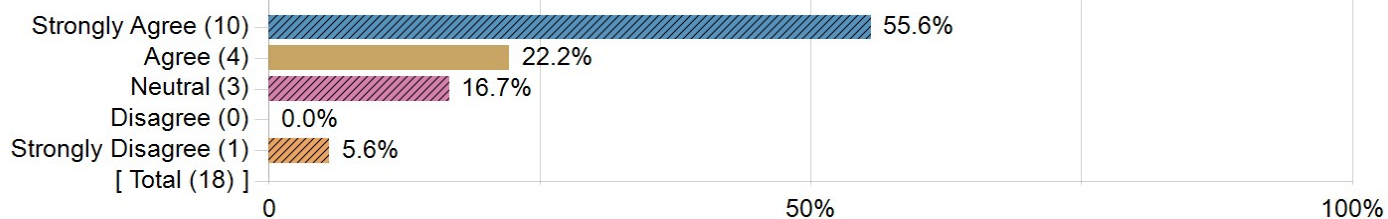
Creation Date: **Friday, June 14, 2024**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



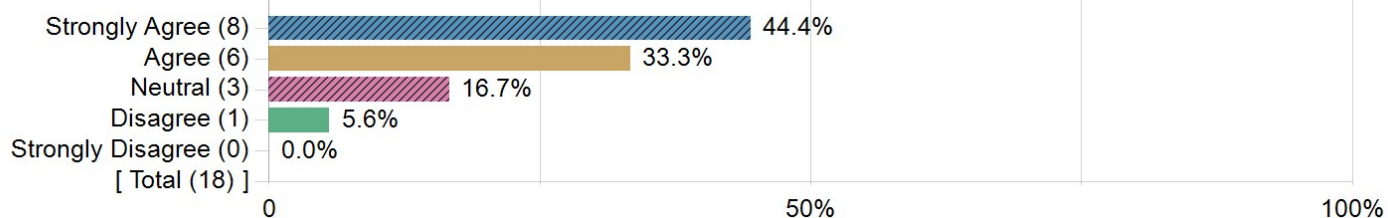
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.22

The course was well organized.



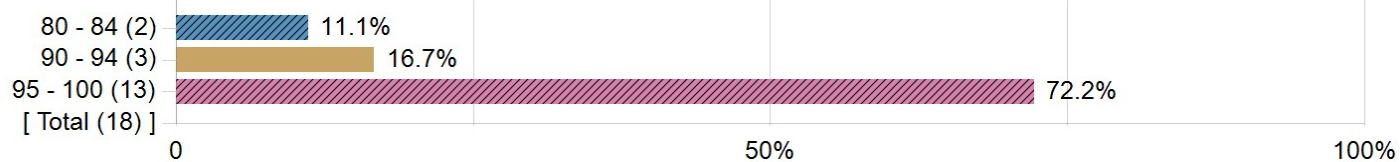
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.17

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



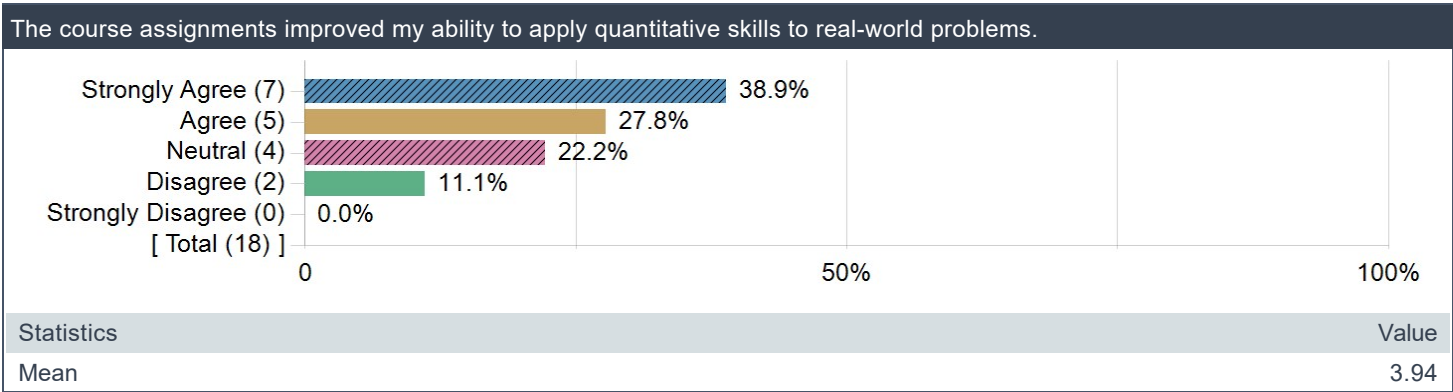
Statistics

Value

Mean

95.61

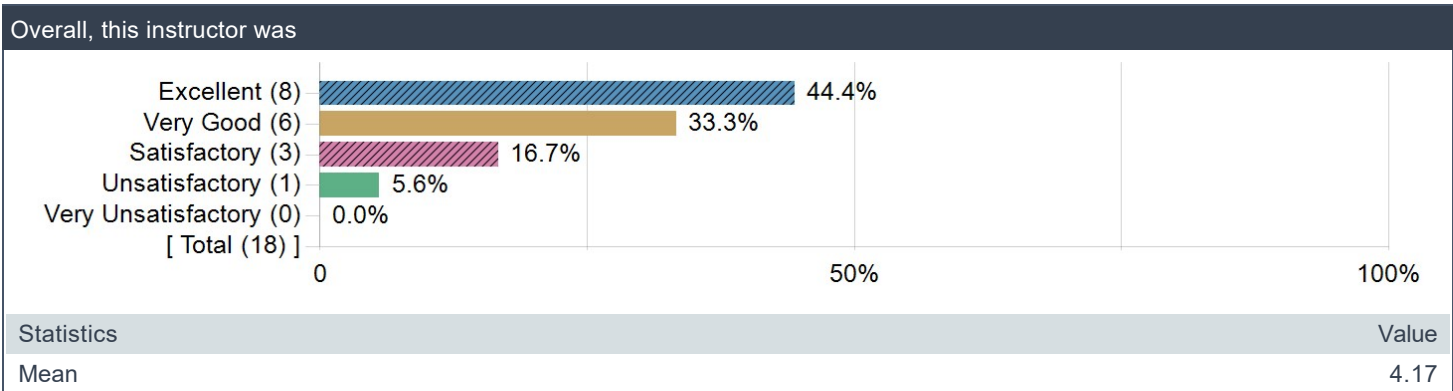
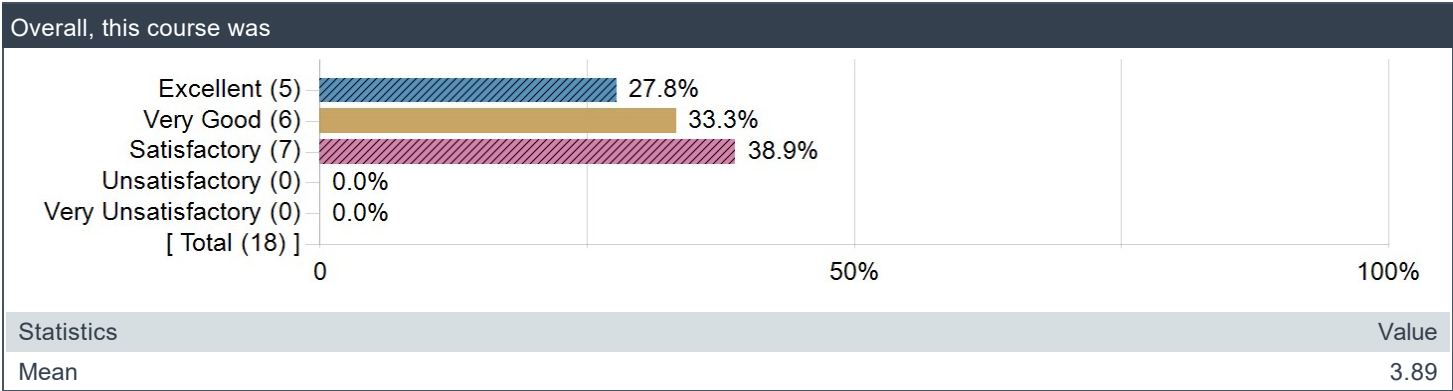
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



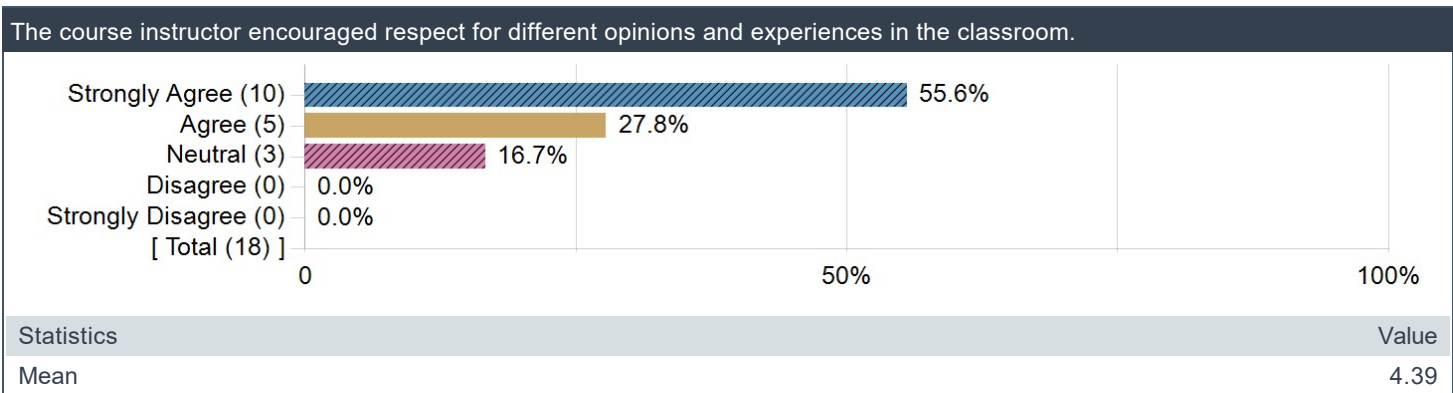
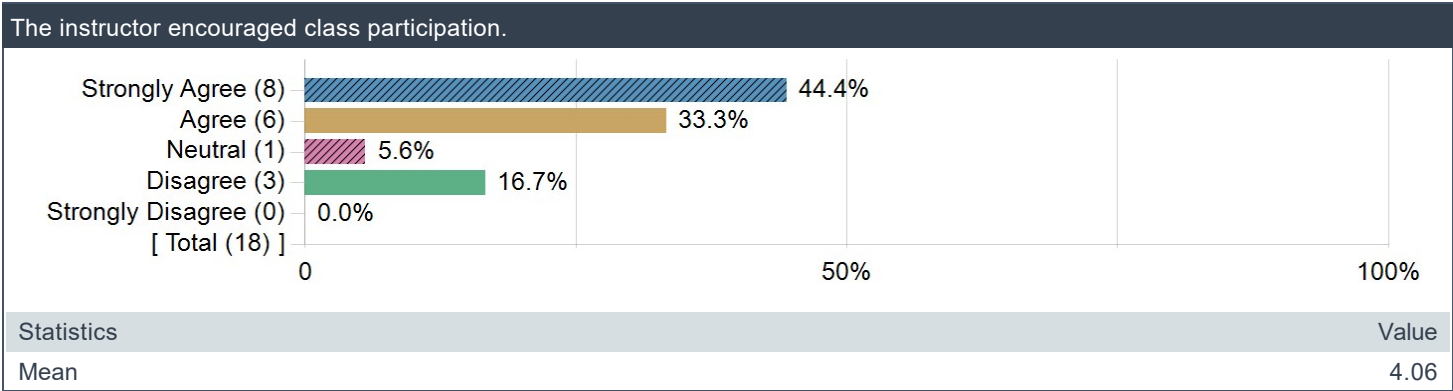
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	50.0%	38.9%	11.1%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.39
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	61.1%	16.7%	22.2%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.39
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	38.9%	44.4%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.22
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	33.3%	33.3%	27.8%	5.6%	0.0%	18	3.94
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	33.3%	44.4%	16.7%	5.6%	0.0%	18	4.06

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Bolfarine explains concepts really well, and I gain a better understanding of the code aspect.
The R sessions led by the TA's
very funny and good teacher
R
Reading the textbook was most effective in helping me learn.
The KCs, the textbook.
n/a
I felt that the lectures by Professor Bolfarine were extremely well taught and easier to understand. Additionally, I found a deeper understanding in the course material through the homework projects assigned throughout the semester.
The KCs were really good at engraving the information in my brain in addition to the check ins at the end of class
Having the book as well as multiple TA hours was helpful but the TA hours were non accessible for me due to them being at times which I had work or when I didn't I had to use the time to complete other assignments.
Helping me stay up to date when I had excused absences.
In class practice
The homework was really beneficial along with the textbook. I really liked the in-class notes with examples as well.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
I think the conceptual matter gets grazed over a little too much, and then it appears on all the exams.
The recurring KCs that were difficult to get 100% especially if they are "select all that apply"
can't think of anything
Not talk for all 75 minutes of class without break
The homework was most challenging as some of it wasn't applicable to what we were learning.
The professor just like keeps on talking, the examples are not neat and concise, great teacher but not effective presenter
keeping up with the content
One of the aspects that I found most challenging were the KC's I found that these were fairly difficult problems but the textbook assist in trying to figure out the solution. I would recommend in the future that the KCs should have reference to a textbook passage that explains the subject the problem pertains to.
definitely learning how hard the midterm was, I feel like if the midterm practice was harder it would have prepared me better
I think the hardest part is the exams in which the time crunch of it is very rigorous. Understanding the code and the answers as fast as possible is important so just lots of practice is necessary.
i think offer more help
Work is just tough.
The whole class was challenging
The midterm is too short in time for the amount of questions. We had one student finish early out of 50. I also recommend that Professor Bolfarine call out those who are talking over him. Many of us value his class time but he starts the class by allowing others to talk over him and doesn't stop side conversations.